30420 - MARKETING ANALYTICS

Group Project Guidelines

Project principle
Connect a business problem to a focused research question, defensible data, appropriate analysis, insight, and action.

BUSINESS PROBLEM → RESEARCH QUESTION → DATA → METHOD → INSIGHT → ACTION

1. Project at a glance

You are provided with course datasets (transactional/behavioral and review/text data) across several industries and categories.

Your group will choose a company or brand, formulate one focused managerial research question (RQ), and use the selected dataset(s) as evidence. The goal is a coherent, decision-oriented analysis.

- Choose a company/brand and one central RQ that could change a marketing decision.
- Use one or two datasets that are plausible for the question and context.
- Apply at least one substantive course method that helps answer the RQ.
- Translate the results into customer or market insight and a specific managerial recommendation for the chosen brand.

2. Two project tracks

Track	What you do	Notes
LG Electronics Track	Frame the project around an LG-relevant managerial question using the approved proxy data.	Shortlisted teams present to LG managers, receive feedback, and compete for partner recognition.
Open Brand Track	Choose a company/brand and get the data in one of three ways: the brand is in a course dataset (direct); a course dataset serves as a defensible proxy; or you bring other data	Brand-data fit must be justified; same academic rubric.

Track	What you do	Notes
	(an alternative dataset, scraped data, or a survey/experiment) with the instructor's prior approval. See the three options below.	

Many datasets contain brand information. If you choose the Open Brand Track, you have three options:

1. Option 1, direct: the brand is directly represented in a course dataset.
2. Option 2, proxy: the brand is not in the course datasets, but an observed brand or category works as a stand-in when the comparison is reasonable. This is generally more defensible for behavioral/transaction data than for review/text data, because review language is often brand- and product-specific. If you use a proxy, briefly state in the final report: (1) what the data actually represent; (2) what you are assuming about the chosen brand; (3) why the proxy is reasonable; and (4) which conclusions should therefore be interpreted cautiously.
3. Option 3, find your own data: the brand is not in the course datasets and no proxy is convincing. Three routes, each requiring the instructor's prior approval: (a) an alternative dataset you identify, (b) data you scrape, (c) a survey or an experiment you run. Send a short plan (data source or survey/experiment design, purpose, feasibility, timeline) by email as early as possible, and no later than the interim-slides deadline. There is no automatic bonus for collecting additional data, although relevant data may improve the quality of your analysis and lead to a higher mark. Use only data you are permitted to collect and use, and document the source, collection dates, filters, sampling, and collection method in the final deliverables.

3. Dataset bank & policy

You can find and download the datasets from the Dropbox link on Blackboard.

The bank contains folders by industry, including:

- LG Track (Consumer electronics / appliances)
- General retail / e-commerce
- Hospitality / travel
- Financial services
- Fashion / apparel
- Restaurants / local services
- Telecom / subscription
- Media / entertainment

Course-provided datasets may be renamed, subsetted, or curated for teaching. Use the dataset name provided in the course folder; you are not expected to identify or cite its original public source. Any additional data you collect yourself must be fully cited and documented.

If you prefer to use data other than the course datasets, follow Option 3 in Section 2 (instructor approval required).

4. Research question and method choice

- A strong RQ identifies a managerial decision, an outcome or customer/market problem, and a context. It must be answerable with the available variables.
- You may apply more than one method, but the substantive analytical methods you use should be ones covered in the course. Descriptive charts and routine data cleaning are not restricted.

An illustrative example of a business problem and research question:

BUSINESS PROBLEM: A brand gets substantial website traffic, but conversion is low and marketing treats most visitors similarly.

→ **RESEARCH QUESTION**: Are there distinct visitor segments with different browsing and purchase behaviors, and which segments appear most commercially attractive?

5. Deliverables and milestones

#	Deliverable	When (Milan time)	Where	File name & notes
1	Interim slides	Sat 31 Oct 2026, 23:59	Blackboard assignment	30420_Interim_Group[N].pdf
2	Tutorial session I	Thu 5 Nov 2026, 12:00–13:30	In class, Aula 34	—
3	Tutorial session II	Mon 16 Nov 2026, 16:30–18:00	In class, Aula 34	—
4	Final slides, final report and coding files	Wed 25 Nov 2026, 23:59	Blackboard assignment	30420_Slides_Group[N].pdf 30420_Report_Group[N].pdf 30420_Files_Group[N].zip or 30420_Files_Group[N].rar
5	Final presentations	Thu 26 Nov 2026, 10:15–13:30	In class, Aula 34	—
6	LG manager presentation	Mon 30 Nov 2026, 16:30–18:00	In class, [TBD]	—
7	Individual peer	After the final presentations, before	Qualtrics (link will be posted	—

	evaluation	project scores are released	on Blackboard)	

Replace [N] with your group number. Example: Group 7 submits 30420_Report_Group7.pdf.

Submission rules

- Each deliverable is submitted through its Blackboard assignment. Only one member of the team uploads on behalf of the whole team; agree in advance who will upload.
- Deadlines are strict. The assignment closes at 23:59 (Milan time) on the due date. No file is accepted after the deadline, by any channel.
- Upload PDF files for slides and reports, named exactly as in the table above.
- The uploaded slides are the slides you present. They will be preloaded on the classroom desktop on the presentation days.

Interim slides (max 5 slides)

- Group number and members.
- Brand choice, business problem, primary RQ, dataset(s) and, optionally, proposed method(s).
- A brief introduction to the company/brand: what it does, what the marketing problem is and why your team picked it. A preliminary version is fine.

Project tutorials

- During each tutorial, groups report their progress to the instructor one at a time and get feedback. Be ready to summarize what you have done since the interim slides and what you plan next.

Note: the content of interim slides and discussions during tutorial sessions are not part of the evaluation and do not count toward the final grade. Treat them as opportunities to get feedback. That said, failing to submit the slides or missing the sessions as a whole team will lead to a point deduction.

Final presentation

- 8 minutes of presentation, followed by 3 minutes of Q&A with the instructors and class.
- Presentation order is randomly assigned and announced on the presentation days.
- Presenters may not read from notes, whether on paper or on a phone.
- Slides should be clear, readable, and visually engaging. Avoid text-heavy blocks and small fonts. Cite all external data and charts; course-provided datasets may be referred to by the dataset name given in the course folder.

Coding files

Submit one .zip or .rar file containing all code/notebooks used to clean and analyze the data and to generate tables, figures, or other outputs.

The workflow must be reproducible. Use consistent file names and relative paths so that the code runs without manual renaming or path edits. If one notebook creates a cleaned or intermediate dataset used by another, save it under the exact filename referenced in the next step.

Final report

- Maximum 12 pages including tables and figures, 1.5 line spacing, 12-pt font, APA style. The reference list does not count toward the page limit. There is no minimum length.

6. Final report logic

Section	What it should answer
Managerial problem	What decision is at stake and why does it matter?
Research question	One clear primary RQ; secondary questions if they support it.
Data	Dataset, unit of analysis, key variables, cleaning, proxy assumptions, and limitations.
Method(s)	Why each method is needed; assumptions/validation where relevant.
Findings	Only results that materially answer the RQ.
Managerial interpretation	What the evidence means for customers, the brand, and the decision.
Recommendation	Specific action, target/channel/timing where relevant, plus trade-offs.
Limitations & next evidence	What you cannot conclude and what data/test you would want next.
Optional: Ethics / privacy / fairness	Material risk and mitigation.

7. AI policy

GenAI may be used to support coding, debugging, and grammar checking. It should not be used to draft the final report. Include a short AI-use disclosure in the final report.

Teams remain fully responsible for all code, numbers, interpretations, and citations. Fabricated or hallucinated content will be penalized.